

Prionailurus planiceps

Flat-headed cat



Length 16–20 in
(41–50 cm)

Tail 5–6 in
(13–15 cm)

Weight 3¼–4½ lb
(1½–2 kg)

Location S.E. Asia

Social unit Individual

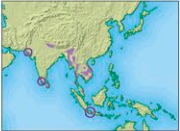
Status Endangered



Unusually small and low-set ears accentuate the flattened forehead of this semiaquatic fish predator, which also eats shrimps, frogs, rodents, and small birds. Its toes are partly webbed and its claws not fully retractable. The upper premolar teeth are relatively large and sharp to grip slippery food. Slightly smaller than a typical pet cat, the flat-headed cat is usually sighted around rivers, lakes, and swamps, and along irrigation ditches and canals.

Prionailurus viverrinus

Fishing cat



Length 22½–43 in
(57–115 cm)

Tail 9½–16 in
(24–40 cm)

Weight 11–35 lb
(5–16 kg)

Location S. to S.E. Asia

Social unit Individual

Status Vulnerable



Olive-gray with black markings and a short tail, the fishing cat is mostly confined to rivers, lakes, marshes, and coastal mangrove swamps. However, its adaptations to water are largely behavioral: its toes are only slightly webbed, and its teeth are not especially suited to grasping slippery prey. Locally common, its dependence on water-edge habitats means its population may suffer as wetlands are affected by drainage, intensive agriculture, human habitation, and pollution.

CIVET-LIKE CAT
This cat's scientific name, viverrinus, reflects its viverrid- or civet-like proportions: long, stocky body and relatively short legs.

FISH DIET



As its name implies, the fishing cat is a semiaquatic hunter of fish, frogs, snakes, water insects, crabs, crayfish, and shellfish. It scoops prey from the water with its paws or dives in pursuit, sometimes surfacing under a water bird. It also hunts small land mammals such as mice.

Profelis aurata

African golden cat



Length 24–39 in
(61–100 cm)

Tail 6½–14 in
(16–35 cm)

Weight 12–35 lb
(5.5–16 kg)

Location W. and C. Africa

Social unit Individual

Status Vulnerable



This little-studied, medium-sized cat may vary from gray to red-brown, and it may be faintly spotted or plain. It occurs primarily in tropical rain forest and other forest habitats, especially near rivers. Its prey is mainly rats and other rodents, hyraxes, small forest antelopes, monkeys (perhaps already injured), and similar small mammals. It may also catch birds, mainly on the ground but also in trees.

Lynx pardinus

Iberian lynx



Length 27–32 in
(68–82 cm)

Tail 5–6½ in
(12.5–16 cm)

Weight 15–31 lb
(7–14 kg)

Location S.W. Europe

Social unit Individual

Status Endangered



Very rare, critically restricted in distribution, and fully protected by law, the Iberian lynx is about half the size of the Eurasian species (see right). Now mainly confined to remote wetlands and uplands, it uses thickets for shelter and open areas that favor its main food of rabbit—with deer fawns, ducks, and other prey in winter.

Lynx lynx

Eurasian lynx



Length 2½–4¼ ft
(0.8–1.3 m)

Tail 6½–9 in
(16–23 cm)

Weight 33–64 lb
(15–29 kg)

Location N. Europe to E. Asia

Social unit Individual

Status Least concern

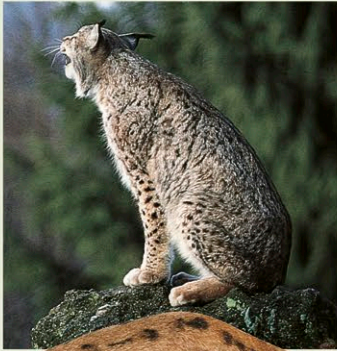


Primarily a cat of mixed forest, this lynx has been driven by human presence and persecution to more open woods and rocky mountain slopes. However, it still has one of the widest ranges of all cat species. Its major prey is deer, goats, sheep, and similar hoofed mammals up to 4 times its own size, but, if these are lacking, it hunts hares and pikas.

COAT PATTERNS
The Eurasian lynx has 3 predominant coat patterns: mainly striped, mostly spotted (as here), and plain.

CONSERVATION

Despite conservation efforts and reintroductions in Western Europe, lynx remain rare because of revenge hunting by livestock farmers, road kills, and mysterious loss of male cubs—possibly caused by a genetic problem.



Lynx rufus

Bobcat



Length 26–43 in
(65–110 cm)

Tail 3½–4¼ in
(9–11 cm)

Weight 8¾–34 lb
(4–15.5 kg)

Location S. Canada, USA, Mexico

Social unit Individual

Status Least concern



Named after its short “bobbed” tail, this medium-sized cat has a ruff-like facial border. Mainly tawny in color, it always has some spots; they may be prominent all over or only on the underside. It hunts lagomorphs, such as cottontail rabbits in the south of its range and snowshoe hares farther north, but can survive on rodents, deer, and carrion. Its habitat varies from desert to mixed woodland and conifer forest.